when Scully and Mulder open the first few dozen boxes—agreeing by phone which door to open on each—they verify the letter's predictions.

Although Mulder and Scully are being presented with a somewhat more complicated situation than previously, at first blush it seems that the same reasoning Scully used earlier applies equally well here.

"Mulder," says Scully, "this is as silly as yesterday's package. Once again, there is no mystery. The sphere inside each box must simply be programmed. Don't you see?"

"But now there are three doors," cautions Mulder, "so the sphere can't possibly 'know' which door we'll choose to open, right?"

"It doesn't need to," explains Scully. "That's part of the programming. Look, here's an example. Grab hold of the next unopened box, box 37, and I'll do the same. Now, imagine, for argument's sake, that the sphere in my box 37 is programmed, say, to flash red if the top door is opened, to flash blue if the side door is opened, and to flash red if the front door is opened. I'll call this program *red, blue, red.* Clearly, then, if whoever is sending us this stuff has input this same program into your box 37, and if we both open the same door, we will see the same color flash. This explains the 'mysterious connection': if the boxes in our respective collections with the same number have been programmed with the same instructions, then we will see the same color if we open the same door. There is *no* mystery!"

But Mulder does not believe that the spheres are programmed. He believes the letter. He believes that the spheres are randomly choosing between red and blue when one of their box's doors is opened and hence he believes, fervently, that his and Scully's boxes *do* have some mysterious long-range connection.

Who is right? Since there is no way to examine the spheres before or during the supposed random selection of color (remember, any such tampering will cause the sphere instantly to choose randomly between red or blue, confounding any attempt to investigate how it really works), it seems impossible to prove definitively whether Scully or Mulder is right.